

CMSI 401 Project Status Sheet

Fall 2005

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Date: 4/8

Project: Stacks

Period Covered: 3/25-4/8

Accomplishments since last report:

- Fixed library catalog integration - Updated search URL patterns for libraries to ensure book search links correctly open each library's catalog
- Implemented AI powered Stack Match feature - Integrated Google Gemini API to provide personalized book recommendations based on user preferences (genre, mood, tropes, micro-tropes) from their Want to Read shelf, with fallback logic using 4+ star reading history
- Built Library Savings Tracker - Created component that calculates and displays estimated money saved by borrowing books from libraries, with real time updates as users log borrowed books
- Redesigned homepage to reflect web app features
- Added SimilarBooks component - Implemented "More by Author" and "Readers Also Enjoyed" sections on Book Detail page using AI-curated recommendations with matching based on themes

Scheduled tasks to be done by next report:

- Design and create senior project poster
- Implement format filters in Discover feature - Add filter options for book formats (physical book, audiobook, ebook, graphic novel, etc)

Noteworthy risks, concerns, or problems:

- No significant risks at this time - all major features are functional

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Explanation of expectations for status reports

Status reports must be specific. Project management will not understand what is going on with the project, and thus be able to track progress and "earned value", unless you provide details. This means they will come bug you later for the details you didn't provide them, and will interrupt your work progress twice for one report. This is not only inefficient, but also can be downright annoying. So, here are some tips for informative status reports. Keep in mind these are good things to present as part of your oral status reports as well.

Under "Accomplishments" it is not sufficient to write "Wrote code". Instead, describe the details of the tasks you completed:

- Held two group meetings and hashed out button placement issues on GUI design.
- Modified two product line windows to the shorter version, as agreed in prior meeting.
- Removed hard-coded path names and replaced them with symbolic references that included separate site, directory, and filename components.
- Replaced the login function with one that made UNIX called, rather than NT calls.

Under "Scheduled tasks" it is not sufficient to write "Write code". Instead, write explicit text describing the task and include the data for scheduled completion:

- Code and standalone test add-manufacturer capability (23 March)
- Complete design, code and standalone test of add-facility capability (25 March)
- Complete facility inspection report generation (29 March)

Under "Risks" it is not sufficient to write "not enough time". Explain what the risk or concern is, how it impacts schedule, and how the problem will be solved:

- Need to travel on other business 30 March - 4 April.
- Will not be able to meet 5 April due date at a result.
- Will link with existing customer interview report generator, rather than redesigning the report using the updated layout and logo, with delivery on 8 April.
- Should be able to include improved customer interview report generator by 15 April.